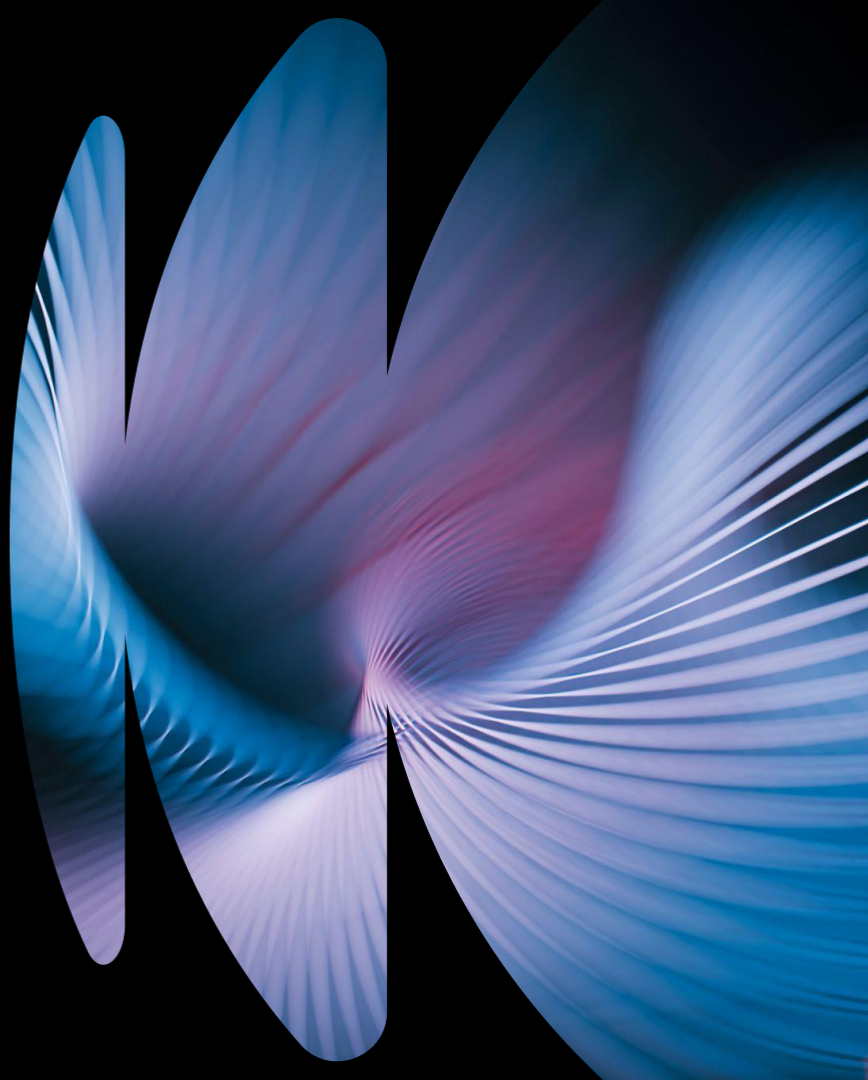
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sstkVertical: Backgrounds

A Shutterstock Content Brief





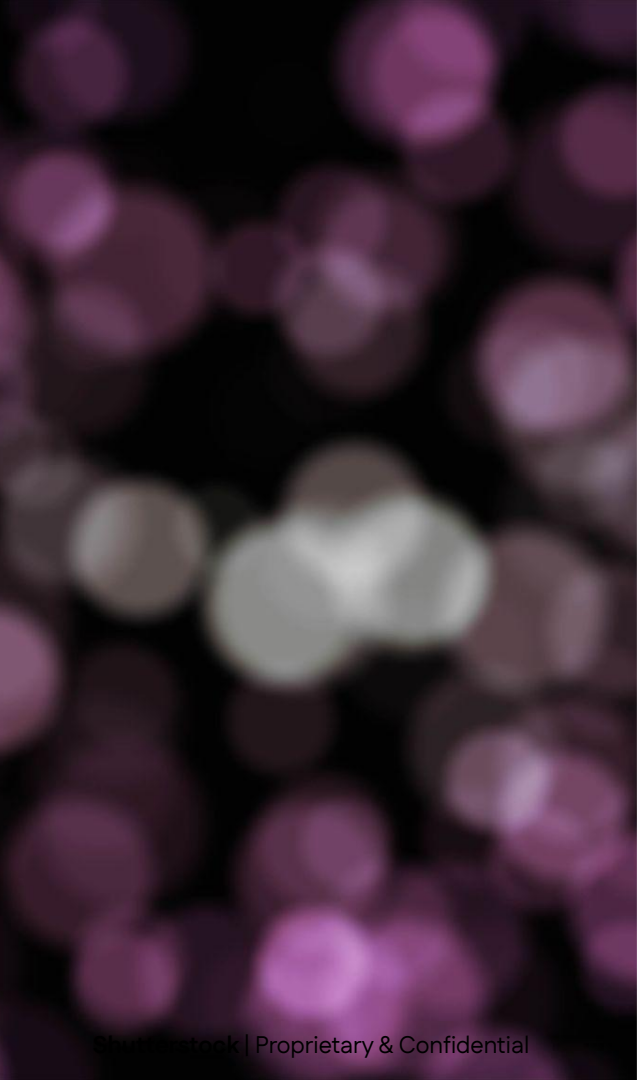
Overview

Vertical backgrounds for storytelling

Vertical video is increasingly the preferred format for mobile-first audiences. Customers are looking for versatile, visually appealing backgrounds that enhance storytelling without distracting from the subject. From abstract animations and textured walls to natural landscapes and urban streets, high-quality backgrounds can elevate content across social media, marketing campaigns, and creative projects.

This content brief aims to provide topic suggestions and guidance for contributors to create vertical video backgrounds that are both engaging and adaptable for a variety of uses.

Make sure to use the keyword **sstkVertical** when submitting content to this brief!



Scenarios

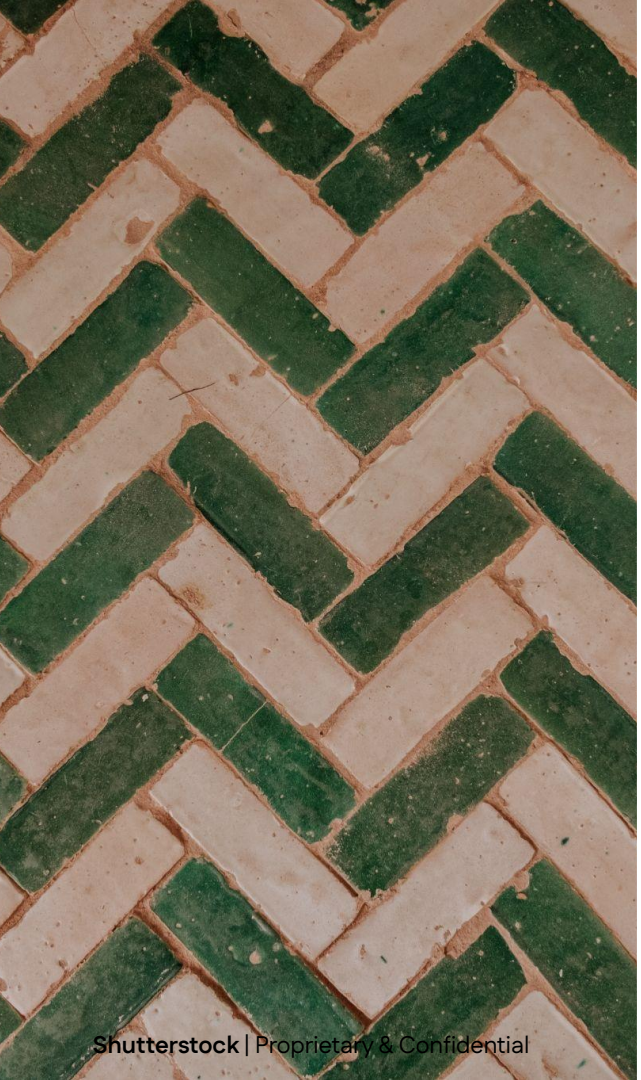
Vertical animated and abstract backgrounds

Subtle Motion & Looped Animations: Animated lines, waves, or geometric shapes that loop seamlessly, creating energy and depth without distracting from the subject.

Abstract Visuals & Gradients: Use flowing particle motion, color gradients, and non-representational imagery to create striking, versatile backdrops.

Living Walls & Rendered Environments: Digitally rendered interiors, textured walls, or atmospheric scenes that provide modern and immersive visual settings.

Geometric, Tech & Conceptual Designs: Bold patterns, clean lines, and dynamic shapes inspired by technology, retro aesthetics, or scientific design, adding movement and visual interest.



Scenarios

Vertical textures and patterned backgrounds

Wood and Stone Surfaces: Close-ups of natural materials like wood grain, stone walls, or marble that add subtle depth and realism.

Fabric and Textiles: Shots of flowing fabrics, woven patterns, or textured upholstery that provide tactile visual interest.

Painted or Wallpapered Walls: Bold or muted patterns, murals, or textured paints that create stylish, versatile backdrops.

Metallic & Reflective Surfaces: Shiny or brushed metals, mirrors, or foil textures that catch light and add dimension.

Abstract Patterns: Geometric, repetitive, or organic designs that create rhythm and visual appeal without overpowering the subject.

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Scenarios

Vertical dynamic and scenic backgrounds

Scenic Vistas & Aerial Textures: Wide vertical shots of natural landscapes, cityscapes, or overhead/top-down views of objects, food, or everyday items that provide scale and perspective.

Nature: Showcase diverse natural environments like deserts, jungles, or wetlands, emphasizing textures, colors, and unique environmental features. Coastal Views: Show waves crashing on the shore, surfers in the distance, or people walking along a beach at sunrise or sunset.

Time-Lapse Environments: Capture accelerated motion of clouds, sunsets, city streets, or bustling crowds to add dynamic energy and sense of time passing.

Seasonal & Weather Effects: Show rain, snow, fog, sunlight filtering through trees, or autumn leaves falling to create mood, atmosphere, and variety for vertical videos.

Shooting video? Keep these specs in mind.

Video Specs

Frame Rate:	23.98p
Resolution:	**Horizontal** (Cinema 4k) 4096x2160 (UHD) 3840x2160 (HD) 1920x1080 **Vertical** HD - 1080x1920 4K - 2160x3840, 2160x4096, 2304 x 4096
Shutter Speed:	180 (1/48th)
Gamma:	Rec 709 Wide Dynamic Range (Cinema Style) Log-C
Compression:	Pro-Res 422 (HQ) H.264 (max bit rate and depth)

Customers want commercial-use content.

Legal Requirements

What is commercial-use content?

As the name suggests, commercial content can be used to commercialize, monetize, sell, promote, and advertise a product, business or service. Content that is licensed for commercial use has many more restrictions than content that is licensed for editorial use because commercial content is used for advertising and promotional purposes.

Please make sure the content you submit to this brief does not have any visible trademarks, intellectual property, and personally identifiable information. All content featuring recognizable people must be submitted with a valid model release.

Make sure customers find your content.

Metadata

Providing relevant and robust metadata is the best way to guide customers to your content.

You can include up to 50 keywords and a 200 character description for each image or clip. Include information about location, occasions, actions, people, clothing, and concepts in your metadata. The more descriptive metadata you provide, the more likely a customer can find and license your content.

Include the keyword **sstkVertical** when submitting content for this request!

Top sstkVertical: Backgrounds keywords

Literal Keywords

If these people, places, or things appear in your content, add them to your keywords.

aerial, abstract, animation, animated, background, background plate, beach, city, clouds, coastal, color, desert, digital, fabric, forest, geometric, hills, interior, landscape, lights, marble, metal, mountains, natural, ocean, particle, pattern, rain, reflections, rocks, sky, snow, stone, street, texture, urban, waterfall, water, waves, woodland, wood

Conceptual Keywords

If these themes, feelings, or ideas are represented in your content, add them to your keywords.

atmosphere, balance, calm, creativity, depth, diversity, energy, focus, harmony, immersion, inspiration, mood, motion, natural, perspective, realism, rhythm, scenic, space, style, texture, versatility, visual, vivid, warmth, wonder, zen, dynamic, abstract, flow

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Thanks!

We can’t wait to see what you create.

Image Credits: Westend61 on Offset, Pro-Design, Addictive Creative, eFlexion